

Tech and Tools Specs - Awaysis

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Foliage Volumes

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Automated

Vignette Spawners

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To increase level creation time and gameplay variety, we should employ the use of vignette spawners.

What is a vignette?

A vignette is a well-placed and grouped selection of assets that provides the opportunity to enhance the gameplay or the aesthetics of a room.

A key tenet of the levels is having variety.

Instead of hand placing each vignette, we should create a library of pre-tested and approved vignettes to draw from and place within the bounds of a spawner.

These spawners would come in set sizes, say 3 x 3 or 5 x 5 and would place pre-constructed assets within. The spawners would be categorized based on what kind of vignette they would place:

Type	Description	Managed by SpawnManager*
Supply 	These are vignettes that provide more healing variety to a room. Crates, barrels etc. Do not mix pots in here	Yes
Loot 	These are vignettes that provide more loot variety to a room. Pots.	Yes
Hazard	These are vignettes that bring something very dangerous to a room. Explosive barrels.	No

Type	Description	Managed by SpawnManager*
		
Fortification 	These are small areas where enemy factions have dug in or placed siege objects, spike wall, fences, some crates barrels etc.	No
Lookout 	Miniature forward camps, usually with towers and supplies just like forts but with towers included.	no
Camp 	These are vignettes for enemy encampments. Just like forts but with tents included.	No? (as long as these aren't spawn points)
Illumination 	Brings lighting to the room in a more dynamic way	no
NPC 	These are vignettes that provide random NPC encounters to the player.	Yes
Deco 	These are vignettes that bring a little more spice of life to the level.	No

*The [Spawn Manager](#), which has a mission-wide view of enemy, loot, and healing item rates, should select Loot, Healing, and NPC vignettes.

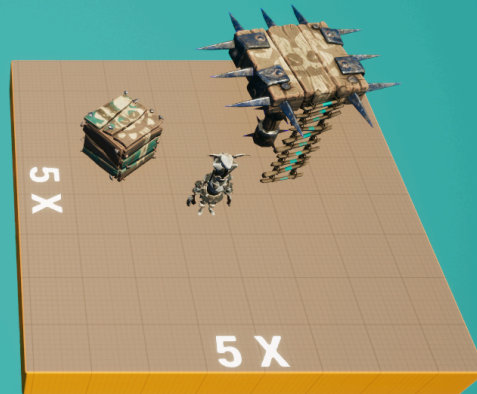
The other vignette types can be randomized by any method, or pre-set per mission type.

Here is a rough visualization of how the vignettes could look.

EXAMPLE CAMP



EXAMPLE CAMP



EXAMPLE DECO

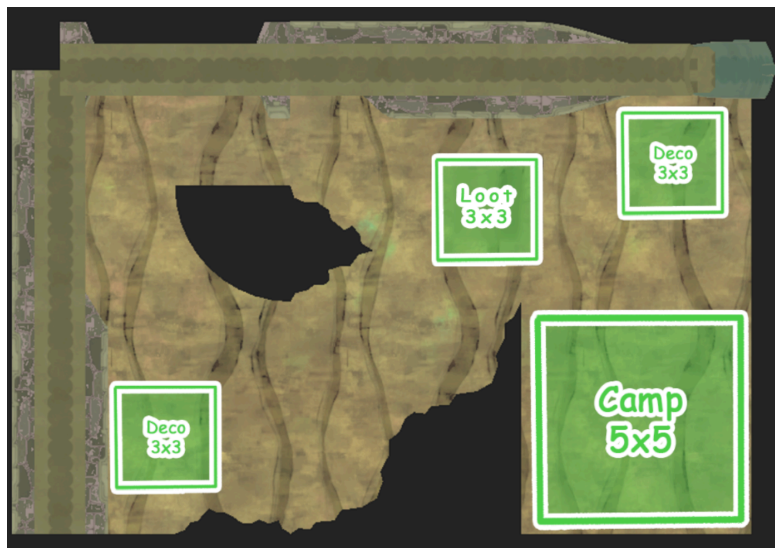


EXAMPLE DECO



(scale is not accurate)

When it comes to actually placing the vignettes in the room, volumes that indicate the spawning area are placed and designers ensure there is no overlapping geo, other spawners etc.



(scale is not accurate)

Once gameplay is initialized then the room places random vignettes in the possible areas.

NOTE: Not all spawners will be used, the room will have more vignette spawners that are actually going to be used. This system of overbooking allows for more variety and balancing where needed.

Example of how this could present based on the above images:



NOTE: Spawner should show a debug that outputs what variety of vignettes were spawned in the room for tracking.